SPONSOR/PARTCIPANT FIRST STEP WORK SHEET

"WE ADMITTED THAT WE WERE POWERLESS OVER OUR ADDICTION, THAT OUR LIVES HAD BECOME UNMANAGEABLE."

THE FIRST MISTAKE THAT MANY OF US MAKE WHEN WE COME INTO THE PROGRAM, IS THAT WE THINK DRUGS ARE THE PROBLEM. WHEN WE SAY TO THE NEWCOMER THAT DRUGS ARE ONLY A SYMPTOM OF A MUCH DEEPER PROBLEM (ADDICTION), IT IS HARD FOR THEM TO UNDERSTAND THIS.

TO GET A BETTER UNDERSTANDING OF ADDICTION, WE MUST LOOK AT THE DISEASE CONCEPT OF ADDICTION. FROM THAT POINT OF VIEW, ADDICTION IS A DISEASE OF ATTITUDES, PERSONALITY AND A GENERAL NEGATIVE OUTLOOK THAT IS ROOTED IN FEAR, INSECURITY AND LOW SELF-ESTEEM. THE MAIN INGREDIENTS OF ADDICTION ARE OBSESSION AND COMPULSION. OBSESSIOON -- THAT FIXED IDEA THAT TAKES US BACK TIIME AND TIME AGAIN TO OUR PARTICULAR DRUG, OR SOME SUBSTITUTE.

(SUBSTITUTE BEING ANYTHING THAT MAKES US FEEL GOOD AND GET INSTANT GRATIFICATION, SUCH AS MONEY, POWER, SEX, FOOD, ANGER, ET.) TO RECAPTURE THE EASE AND COMFORT WE ONCE KNEW. ONE DRINK OR ONE SUBSTITUTE WE CANNOT STOP THROUGH OUR OWN POWER OF WILL. BECAUSE OF OUR PHYSICAL SENSITIVITY TO DRUGS AND ANYTHING THAT MAKES US FEEL GOOD, WE ARE COMPLETELY IN THE GRIP OF A DESTRUCTIVE POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES.

LOOKING AT ADDICTION FROM THAT POINT OF VIEW, WE SEE HOW ADDICTION MAKES OUR LIVES UNMANAGEABLE WITH OR WITHOUT DRUGS. AT THIS POINT WSE MUST SURRENDER AND ACCEPT HOW POWERLESS WE ARE OVER OUR ADDICTION. WHEN WE DO THIS A VERY STRANGE THING HAPPENS, WE BEGIN TO GAIN POWER THROUGH WE (WE) PART OF THE PROGRAM AND THE NEXT ELEVEN STEPS. IT HAS OFTEN BEEN SAID THAT THE FIRST STEP IS OUR PAST AND THE THINGS OF OUR PAST THAT ARE WITH US TODAY. AND THE NEXT ELEVEN STEPS ARE OUR FUTURE.

NOW THAT WE HAVE A BETTER UNDERSTANDING OF OUR ADDICTION, LET US LOOK AT SOME WAYS WE CAN APPLY THE FIRST STEP IN OUR DAILY LIVES. THE MOST OBVIOUS IS THAT WE CAN'T PICK UP THAT FIRST FIX, PILL OR DRINK AND TO THIS JUST FOR TODAY. LET'S NOW TAKE A LOOK AT SOME NON-CHEMICAL WAS WE MUST APPLY THIS STEP IN OUR LIVES.

1. YOU GO OUT TO YOUR CAR IN THE MORNING AND IT HAS A FLAT TIRE. RATHER THATN FEEDING INTO THE ADDICTION ATTITUDES OF ANGER OR FRUSTRATION, WHICH WILL CREATE UNMANAGEABILITY, WE MUST ACCEPT AND SURRENDER TO THE FACT THAT THE TIRE'S FLAT AND TAKE ACTION TO CORRECT THE SITUATION. AS ADDICTS WE TEND TO RESIST THE ACT OF SURRENDERING AND USING THS STEP ON EVERY DAY PROBLEMS, MAKIKNG OUR LIVES UNMANAGEABLE.

2. ANOTHER SITUATION COULD BE YOU GO OUT TO YOUR CAR AND YOU START IT P AND THE MOTOR DIES. IT CAN'T BE FIXED. YOU NEED IT FOR YOUR JOB. YOU MUST BE ABLE TO APPLY THE FIRST STEP TO THIS SITUATION. ACCEPT AND SURRENDER THAT THE CAR CANNOT BE FIXED AND YOU THEN GAIN THE POWER TO MOVE FORWARD TO FIND ALTERNATE TRANSPORTATION. YOU CAN REFUSE TO SURRENDER AND APPLY THE STEP AND LET YOUR LIFE BECOME UNMANAGEABLE. THE CHOICE IS YOURS. AS YOU SEE THE FIRST STEP CAN BE AND MUST BE APPLIED TO ALL AREAS OF OUR LIVES. THIS IS CALLED LIVING THE STEPS. THE BOTTOM LINE IS DRUGS ARE ONE SYMPTOM OF OUR DISEASE. THE ONLY RELIEF WE GET FROM OUR DISEASE IS BY WORKING THE STEPS. IT IS A NEW AND EXCITING EXPERIENCE THAT WILL BRING MANY CHANGES INTO OUR LIVES. THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS YOUR ARE TO WRITE ABOUT ON A SEPARATE SHEET OF PAPER AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR.

1. WHAT IS THE DISEASE OF ADDICTION?
2. WHY IS BEING CLEAN NOT ENOUGH?
3. HOW WAS MY LIFE UNMANAGEABLE IN MY ADDICTION?
4. HOW IS MY LIFE UNMANAGEABLE IN RECOVERY?
5. HOW DO I APPLY THE FIRST STEP IN MY LIFE?
6. HOW ARE OUR STEPS DIFFERENT THAN ANY OTHER 12 STEP PROGRAM?
7. AM I WILLING TO ACCEPT THE STEPS AS A WAY OF LIFE?

ONE LAST THING THAT MUST BE POINTED OUT IS THE WE PORTION OF THIS STEP AND ALL OUR STEPS. ALL OF OUR STEPS BEGIN WITH WE EXCEPT THE 12TH HAS THE WORD WE IN THE CENTER. THIS MAKES US DIFFERENT THAN ANY OTHER 12 STEP PROGRAM. NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS IS A WE PROGRAM NOT A ME PROGRAM. PART OF OUR STRENGTH AND POWER COMES FROM WE. TOGETHER WE CAN. I CAN'T, WE CAN. THIS IS WHY WE NEED MEETINGS FOR THE REST OF OUR LIVES. THIS IS WHY WE NEED CONTACT DAILY WITH OTHER RECOVERING ADDICTS. ANOTHER QUESTION MANY NEWCOMERS ASK IS, IF I STOP USING, I SHOULD BE CURED AND I DON'T NEED THE PROGRAM OR MEETINGS ANYMORE. THE ONLY WAY I KNOW TO CLEAR UP THIS DENIAL IS TO ANSWER THIS WAY: A NON-ADDICT (A NON-ADDICT IS A PERSON WHO DOES NOT HAVE THE ADDIVTIVE PERSONALITY) WHO DOES TO THE HOSPITAL FOR AN OPERATION IS GIVEN A PHYSICALLY ADDICTIVE DRUG FOR PAIN DURING A PERIOD OF TWO WEEKS. HE BECOMES PHYSICALLY ADDICTED. THEY DETOX HIM AND HE GOES ON WITH HIS LIFE WITH OUT ANY PROBLEM. HOWEVER, ADDICTS WITH THE DISEASE OF ADDICTION, HAVE ADDICTIVE PERSONALITIES, WE WERE ADDICTED LONG BEFORE WE USED.

SPONSOR/SPONSEE STEP TWO WORKSHEET

"WE CAME TO BELIEVE THAT A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES COULD RESTORE US TO SANITY."

THE INSANITY REFERRED TO IN THIS STEP IS NOT THE INSANITY OF USING DRUGS. WE WERE RESTORED TO THE SANITY OF NOT USING BY SURRENDERING TO STEP 1 WE NOW FIND OURSELVES CLEAN AND OUR LIVES STILL ARE UNMANAGEABLE IN MANY AREAS. MUCH OF THAT UNMANAGEABILITY COMES FROM DOING THE SAME THING OVER AND OVER AGAIN, AND EXPECTION DIFFERENT RESULTS EACH TIME. OF COURSE, THE RESULTS ARE ALWAYS THE SAME UNMANAGEABILITY AND INSANITY IN OUR LIVES. BUT WHAT IS THERE LEFT TO DO, GO ON THE BEST WE CAN, OR BEGIN TO CHANGE WITH THE SECOND STEP AS OUR GUIDE THROUGH ONGOING RECOVERY.

THE NEXT QUESTION WE BEGIN TO ASK IS: WHAT IS THIS POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES? MANY OF US IMMEDIATELY THOUGHT THIS MEANT OUR HIGHER POWER, BUT WE ARE NOT INTRODUCED TO A HIGHER POWER UNTIL THE THIRD STEP. OUR HIGHER POWER IS THE ULTIMATE POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES, WHATEVER OUR CONCEPT OF A HIGHER POWER IS. HOWEVER, THIS IS NOT THE POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES THAT WE ARE REFERRING TO IN THE SECOND STEP. THE BEST WAY TO EXPLAIN THIS IS THAT A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES CAN CHANGE FROM SITUATION TO SITUATION I LIKE TO CALL IT GIFTS FROM MY HIGHER POWER. A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES CAN BE THE NA PROGRAM, A SPONSOR, ANOTHER PERSON, PAIN OR SOMETHING WE MAY READ, ETC. IT IS ANYTHING THAT MAKES US AWARE OF THE INSANITY OF DOING THE SAME THING OVER AND OVER AGAIN AND EXPECTING DIFFERENT RESULTS OR MAKES YOU AWARE OF THE INSANITY OF A SITUATION IF WE ACT OUT ON A DEFECT OR NEGATIVE WILL.

NOW HAVING AN UNDERSTANDING OF THE SECOND STEP, LET'S TAKE A LOOK AT SOME OF THE WAYS WE CAN APPLY THE SECOND STEP INTO OUR LIVES.

1. THE FIRST WAY WE APPLIED THIS STEP WHEN WE COME INTO THE PROGRAM WAS THAT NA BECOMES A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES. IT HELPS US GET THROUGH EARLY PROBLEMS WITHOUT USING AND TEACHES US DIFFERENT WAYS OF DOING THING.

2. SOMETHING SOMEONE MAY SHARE WITH US CAN BECOME A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES, IF IT MAKES US AWARE OF SOMETHING WE ARE DOING IN THE WRONG WAY SO WE CAN THEN CHANGE IT.

3. PAIN MANY TIMES BECOMES A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES. SOMETIMES IT IS THE ONLY THING THAT WILL MAKE US DO SOMETHING IN A DIFFERENT WAY TO GET SANE RESULTS.

4. A SPONSOR OR SOME OTHER RECOVERING ADDICT CAN BECOME A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES, BY MAKING US AWARE OF THE WAY WE ARE DOING THINGS.

YOU CAN NOW SEE A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES CAN CHANGE FROM SITUATION TO SITUATION. THE IMPORTANT THING IS TO BE AWARE OF HOW TO APPLY THIS PRINCIPLE IN YOUR LIFE SO THAT INSANITY AND UNMANAGEABILITY DOES NOT TAKE HOLD. THE PRINCIPLE OF THE STEP CAN BE A POWER GREATER THAN OURSELVES.

THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS, YOU ARE TO WRITE ABOUT ON A SEPARATE SHEET OF PAPER AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR.

1. WHAT IS A POWER GREATER THAN YOURSELF?

2. WHAT TYPE OF SANITY IS THE SECOND STEP REFERRING TO?

3. HOW CAN I APPLY THIS STEP INTO MY LIFE?

4. WHAT DOES THIS STEP MEAN TO ME?

SPONSOR/SPONSEE THIRD STEP WORKSHEET

"WE MADE A DECISION TO TURN OUR WILL AND OUR LIVES OVER TO THE CAR OF GOD AS WE UNDERSTOOD HIM."

THIS HAS OFTEN BEEN REFERRED TO AS A STUMBLING BLOCK OF RECOVERY. MANY OF US JUST GET STUCK HERE AND CAN'T SEEM TO MOVE ON. THE REASON FOR THIS, AS ADDICTS WE LIKE TO TAKE SOMETHING SIMPLE AND COMPLICATE IT, BUT IT DOESN'T HAVE TO BE THAT WAY IF WE BECOME WILLING AND OPEN MINDED. NOW WITH THAT IN MIND LET'S LOOK AT THIS STEP BEGINNING WITH THE WORD DECISION. WHAT IS A DECISION? A DECISION IS AN ACTION WORD, IT IS A BEGINNING, A STARTING POINT OF RECOVERING, IT IS THE TIME WE LET GO OF OUR OLD ATTITUDES AND LET THE STEPS BEGIN TO BUILD NEW ATTITUDES IN OUR LIVES AS WE MAKE MISTAKES AND GROW IN SPIRITUAL PRINCIPLES. AS YOU CAN NOW SEE, BEING WILLING AND OPEN MINDED IS VERY IMPORTANT AS FAR AS DECISION AND THE THIRD STEP ARE CONCERNED. SIMPLY PUT A DECISION IS ACCEPTING THIS STEP INTO OUR LIVES.

THE NEXT PART OF THIS STEP WE MUST LOOK AT IS "TO TURN OUR WILL AND OUR LIVES." WE MUST ASK OURSELVES, WHAT DOES THE STEP MEAN BY OUR WILL AND OUR LIVES. OUR WILL IS OUR WAY OF DOING THINGS. WE ALWAYS WANT TO FIX THINGS' TO THE WAY WE WANT THEM NO MATTER WHO IT HURTS OR DESTROYS. IT COMES FROM THE CORE OF OUR DISEASE, SELF-CENTEREDNESS. THERE IS ONLY ONE POWER THAT CAN DESTROY SELF-CENTEREDNESS AND THAT IS SPIRITUALITY. WE ARE NOW BEGINNING TO BUILD SPIRITUALITY IN OUR LIVES, WHICH WE GET A REALIZATION OF ITS STRENGTH AND POWER IN THE ELEVENTH STEP. OUR LIVES SIMPLY MEANS OUR DAY TO DAY AFFAIRS. OUR PROBLEMS, OUR WORRIES AND OUR PAIN.

NOW LET'S LOOK AT THE WORDS "OVER TO THE CARE OF GOD AS WE UNDERSTOOD HIM." MANY OF US COULDN'T OR WOULDN'T RELATE TO THAT WORD GOD. BY THE TIME WE REACHED NA MANY OF US WERE ATHEISTS OR AGNOSTICS AND SOME OF US HAD A GOD WHO WAS VENGEFUL. HERE AGAIN IS WHERE WE NEED TO BE WILLING AND OPEN MINDED AND HONEST. THE TYPE OF HONESTY WE ARE TALKING ABOUT HERE IS SELF HONESTY. WE MUST BE HONEST ENOUGH TO ADMIT THAT THERE IS A POWER THAT IS HIGHER THAN OURSELVES. IT DOESN'T MATTER WHAT THIS POWER IS. THE PROGRAM TELLS US GOD AS WE UNDERSTOOD HIM. IT DOESN'T HAVE TO BE A GOD OF SOMEONE ELSE'S BELIEF, BUT A GOD OF YOUR BELIEF. THIS IS WHERE MUCH CONFUSION COMES IN THE PROGRAM. AS ADDICTS SOMETIMES WE TRY TO PUSH OUR GOD AND OUR BELIEFS ABOUT HIM ONTO OTHER ADDICTS. I HAVE HEARD SOME ADDICTS TELL ANOTHER ADDICT TO GET DOWN ON HIS KNEES TO PRAY TO GOD WITHOUT EVEN KNOWING IF THAT IS

THE GOD OF THAT ADDICTS' UNDERSTANDING. THE IMPORTANT THING TO REMEMBER IS THAT IT IS A GOD OF YOUR UNDERSTANDING. IT COULD BE THE GOD OF YOUR CHILDHOOD OR A FORCE, NATURE, SOME KIND OF INTELLIGENCE OR JUST A ROCK IN THE BACKYARD. IT IS A HIGHER POWER YOU AND YOU ALONE CAN HAVE FAITH IN. YOU RELATE AND PRAY TO YOUR HIGHER POWER ACCORDING TO THE WAY YOU UNDERSTAND HIM. THE HIGHER POWER YOU HAVE TODAY MAY CHANGE DURING ONGOING RECOVERY AND THAT'S OKAY - IT'S YOUR HIGHER POWER. NOW LET'S TALK ABOUT "OVER TO THE CARE OF." ONE MISTAKE WE MAKE WHEN WE DON'T UNDERSTAND THIS WORD CARE. WITHOUT THE WORD CARE WE CHANGE THE ENTIRE MEANING OF THE STEP. LET ME GIVE YOU AN EXAMPLE OF THIS. IT'S SATURDAY NIGHT AND YOU AND YOUR WIFE/HUSBAND ARE GOING OUT FOR THE NIGHT AND HAVE A CHILD, YOU DON'T TURN YOUR CHILD OVER TO A BABYSITTER BUT YOU TURN THE CARE OF YOUR CHILD OVER TO A BABYSITTER TO WATCH AND GUIDE. WHEN WE TURN OUR WILL AND LIVES OVER TO THE CARE OF GOD WE DO THIS TO HAVE THE HIGHER POWER OF OUR UNDERSTANDING WATCH AND GUIDE OUR WILL AND LIVES.

THE QUESTION HAS BEEN ASKED MANY TIMES WHAT IS GOD'S WILL FOR ME. THE ANSWER IS SIMPLE, GOD'S WILL FOR US IS TO ACT MATUE AND RESPONSIBLE AND TO DO THE BEST OF OUR ABILITY, AT WHATEVER POINT OF OUR RECOVERY WE ARE AT. GOD'S WILL FOR US GROWS AS WE GROW. IF WE ACT MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE TO THE BEST OF OUR ABILITY THE OUTCOME OF A SITUATION WE BE AS MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE AS IT CAN BE AT THAT POINT OF RECOVERY. NOW, WHEN WE TURN OUR LIVES OVER TO THE CARE OF GOD AS WE UNDERSTOOD HIM, TWO THINGS WILL HAPPEN. LET'S LOOK AT WHAT THESE TWO THINGS ARE:

1. IF WE ARE LIVING THE FIRST THREE STEPS IN OUR LIVES IN ALL THINGS, IN OTHER WORDS WE ARE LIVING MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE, OUR HIGHER POWER WILL WORK THINGS OUT FOR US.

2. IF WE ARE NOT LIVING THE FIRST THREE STEPS IN OUR LIVES OUR HIGHER POWER WILL ALLOW US TO FEEL THE CONSEQUENCES OF OUR ACTIONS, SO WE CAN LEARN FROM THEM, SO WE CAN ACT MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE.

WHEN WE FIRST CAME INTO THE PROGRAM OF NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS WE WERE PHYSICALLY, MENTALLY AND SPIRITUALLY BANKRUPT. THE FIRST STEP RESTORED US PHYSICALLY. THE SECOND STEP RESTORED US MENTALLY AND THE THIRD STEP RESTORED US SPIRITUALLY. WE MUST MAINTAIN VIGILANCE OVER THESE THREE ASPECTS OF OUR DISEASE. THE FIRST TO GO WILL BE THE SPIRITUAL, THE SECOND TO GO WILL BE MENTAL/ EMOTIONAL PART OF OUR DISEASE. THE NEXT AND FINAL WILL BE

THE PHYSICAL, THE ACT OF PICKING UP AGAIN. THAT IS WHY IT IS SO IMPORTANT TO LIVE THESE STEPS IN OUR LIVES, IT IS THE MAINTENANCE OF OUR PROGRAM. IF YOU HAVE NO HIGHER POWER TRY G.O.D. (GOOD ORDERLY DIRECTION).

ONE LAST THING WE WILL TALK ABOUT IS THE RELATIONSHIP OF THE SERENITY PRAYER TO THE FIRST THREE STEPS. ONCE WE REALIZE THE CONNECTION BETWEEN THE FIRST TWO, THE SERENITY PRAYER BECOMES A POWERFUL TOOL IN OUR LIVES. LET'S TAKE A LOOK AT IT.

GOD GRANT ME THE SERENITY TO ACCEPT THE THINGS I CANNOT CHANGE. FIRST STEP SURRENDER AND ACCEPT MYSELF.

THE COURAGE TO CHANGE THE THINGS I CAN. THE SECOND STEP DOING THINGS DIFFERENTLY TO CHANGE THE OUTCOME FROM INSANE RESULTS.

AND THE RESULTS TO KNOW THE DIFFERENCE. THIS IS THE THIRD STEP DOING THE MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE THING NOT OUR WILL.

WRITE THE FOLLOWING ON A SEPARATE PAPER AND RETURN SO WE CAN GO OVER IT.

1. WHAT IS A DECISION?

2. HOW I MADE MY DECISION?

3. WHAT IS MY WILL AND LIFE?

4. HOW DO I TURN MY WILL AND LIFE OVER TO GOD?

5. WHY IS IT OK TO HAVE A DIFFERENT HIGHER POWER THAN YOU?

6. WHY DO I HAVE TO LIVE THE STEPS IN MY LIFE?

7. WHAT ARE THE THREE PHASES OF RELAPSE?

8. HOW CAN THE SERENITY PRAYER HELP ME IN MY LIFE?

9. WHY IS BEING CLEAN WITHOUT LIVING THE STEPS DANGEROUS?

SPONSOR/SPONSEE FOURTH STEP WORKSHEET

"WE MADE A SEARCHING AND FEARLESS MORAL INVENTORY OF OURSELVES."

MANY OF US SAT WITH A FOURTH STEP GUIDE AND LOOKED AT IT WITH FEAR. WE ASK OURSELVES IS THIS NECESSARY? THE PURPOSE OF THIS WORKSHEET IS TO PREPARE US FOR THIS STEP. WHEN WE UNDERSTAND THIS STEP AND WHY IT MUST BE DONE, OUR ATTITUDE CAN BE OF POSITIVE EXPECTATION, RATHER THAN ONE OF FEAR AND PANIC.

NOW LET'S TAKE A LOOK AT WHAT THE FOURTH STEP IS ABOUT. WHAT IS A MORAL INVENTORY? MOST OF US ARE PRETTY GOOD AT TAKING AN INVENTORY OF SOMEONE ELSE WITHOUT EVEN KNOWING THE FACTS AND MOTIVES CONNECTED WITH THAT PERSON, BUT NOW WE ARE GOING TO TAKE OUR OWN INVENTORY, USING SELF HONESTY ON ALL THE FACTS AND FEELINGS CONNECTED WITH OUR ATTITUDE, PERSONALITIES AND BEHAVIORS. THAT IS EXACTLY WHAT A MORAL INVENTORY IS. WE ARE GOING TO LOOK AT OUR VALUES AND MORALS THROUGHOUT OUR LIVES, INCLUDING NOW.

WHEN YOU BEGIN TO WRITE ON THE TOPICS IN YOUR GUIDE, YOU ARE NOT TO WRITE JUST YOUR PERSONAL HISTORY, BUT THE FEELINGS CONNECTED WITH THE ACT AS WELL AS THE FEELINGS YOU HAVE ABOUT THEM TODAY. YOU MAY ASK WHY SO MUCH CONCERN ABOUT FEELINGS? THE REASON FOR THIS IS THE FOURTH STEP IS GOING TO INTRODUCE YOU TO YOUR REAL SELF. THE PURPOSE OF THIS STEP IS NOT TO JUDGE YOU, BUT LET YOU BECOME AWARE OF YOURSELF AS YOU WERE IN YOUR PAST AND HOW YOU ARE TODAY, SO YOU KNOW WHAT YOU NEED TO CHANGE IN YOUR LIFE, ATTITUDES, AND BEHAVIOR. THIS STEP WILL ALSO RELEASE THE STORED UP GUILT YOU HAVE BEEN CARRYING WITH YOU. YOU WILL REALIZE YOU ARE NOT RESPONSIBLE FOR MANY OF THE THINGS YOU DID IN YOUR ADDICTION. YOUR DISEASE IS RESPONSIBLE FOR THAT. YOU WILL BECOME AWARE, HOWEVER, THAT YOU ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR RECOVERY. THERE ARE NO LONGER EXCUSES, BECAUSE YOU REALIZE YOU MUST LIVE THE STEPS DAILY OR YOU WILL DIE SPIRITUALLY, EMOTIONALLY AND PHYSICALLY.

THE FIRST THREE STEPS GAVE US A FUNDATION TO BE ABLE TO LIVE LIFE ON ITS OWN TERMS. THE FOURTH THROUGH NINTH STEPS ARE THE CLEANSING AND RELEASE STEPS THAT WILL GIVE THE POWER TO LIVE LIFE. THE TENTH THROUGH TWELFTH STEPS ARE THE MAINTENANCE STEPS, SO YOU CAN SEE WE CAN'T TAKE ANY OF THE STEPS LIGHTLY. KNOWING NOW THAT THE FOURTH STEP IS ONE DOORWAY TO THE CLEANSING AND RELEASE STEPS, WE CAN GO FORWARD WITH AN ATTITUDE OF POSITIVE EXPECTATION FOR THE NEW LIFE WE ARE GROWING INTO. YOU MUST BEGIN

THE FOURTH STEP BY SETTING THE GOAL OF WRITING DAILY. DON'T TRY TO WRITE THE PERFECT MANUSCRIPT.

WRITE AS HONEST AS YOU CAN AND DON'T GO BACK OVER IT AND EDIT ANY OF IT. IF YOU CAN'T REMEMBER WHAT YOU WROTE, THAT IS OKAY. IT WON'T HURT TO WRITE THE SAME AGAIN. KEEP YOUR ATTITUDE POSITIVE, THE PURPOSE OF THIS IS FOR YOU TO GET TO KNOW YOURSELF BETTER.

WHEN YOU ARE DONE WITH YOUR FOURTH STEP YOU WILL KEEP IT TO IDENTIFY PATTERNS, DEFECTS, SHORTCOMINGS AND AMENDS. YOU WILL NEED THIS WHEN WORKING THE OTHER CLEANSING AND RELEASE STEPS. AS YOU BEGIN TO WRITE, EVEN THOUGH YOU ARE DOING THE WORK, YOU ARE NOT ALONE. YOUR HIGHER POWER, AND THE NA PROGRAM AND THE WE OF THE PROGRAM ARE WITH YOU.

WRITE OUT THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS ON A SEPARATE SHEET OF PAPER AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR.

1. WHAT IS A MORAL INVENTORY OF OURSELVES?

2. WHAT QUALITY OF CHARACTER MUST BE USED IN TAKING AN INVENTORY?

3. WHY IS THE FOURTH STEP SO IMPORTANT?

4. WHAT DO FEELINGS HAVE TO DO WITH A FOURTH STEP?

5. WHY IS A FOURTH STEP NOT A HISTORY, A CONFESSION AND A JUDGMENT?

6. WHAT WILL THE FOURTH STEP DO FOR YOU?

7. ARE YOU RESPONSIBLE FOR YOUR PAST?

8. WHAT ARE YOU RESPONSIBLE FOR?

9. WHEN WILL YOU START YOUR FOURTH STEP AND HOW ARE' YOU GOING TO DO IT?

10. WHAT ARE THE FOUNDATION STEPS?

11. WHAT ARE THE CLEANSING AND RELEASE STEPS?

12. WHAT ARE THE MAINTENANCE STEPS?

SPONSOR/SPONSEE FIFTH STEP WORKSHEET

"WE ADMITTED TO GOD, TO OURSELVES, AND TO ANOTHER HUMAN BEING THE EXACT NATURE OF OUR WRONGS."

THE PURPOSE OF THIS WORKSHEET IS TO PREPARE YOU TO DO YOUR FIFTH STEP. ONCE YOUR FOURTH STEP IS DONE, DON'T LOOK AT IT. PUT IT AWAY UNTIL YOU SIT DOWN WITH YOUR SPONSOR. MANY OF US ADDICTS PUT OFF DOING THE FIFTH STEP AFTER WE FINISHED OUR FOURTH STEP BECAUSE OF FEAR. THIS FEELING OF FEAR IS WITH US BECAUSE WE DON'T REALLY UNDERSTAND THE FIFTH STEP. THE REASON WE ARE DOING A FIFTH STEP IS TO HAVE SOMEONE HELP US TO KNOW OURSELVES AND GIVE US DIRECTION BASED ON THEIR EXPERIENCE IN WORKING A PROGRAM OF RECOVERY. AS AN ADDICT IT IS QUITE NORMAL TO WANT TO ISOLATE AND SAY WE CAN DO IT ALONE AND EACH TIME WE DO THAT WE GET OURSELVES IN TROUBLE. REMEMBER THE SECOND STEP TELLS US WE MUST DO THINGS DIFFERENTLY IF WE WANT A DIFFERENT OUTCOME. WE MUST REACH OUT FOR TRUST TO BE DELIVERED FROM THE INSANITY OF ISOLATION.

THE PURPOSE OF SHARING YOUR FOURTH STEP WITH ANOTHER PERSON AND YOUR HIGHER POWER IS NOT TO JUDGE YOU BUT TO HELP YOU KNOW YOURSELF AND GUIDE YOU IN AREAS THAT YOU NEED HELP. TWO OF THE MOST IMPORTANT QUALITIES YOU WILL GET FROM DOING A FIFTH STEP IS OPEN MINDEDNESS AND WILLINGNESS. A SPIRITUAL AWAKENING YOU WILL RECEIVE IS THAT YOU ARE NOT UNIQUE AND DIFFERENT. YOU FIND THAT BY SHARING YOUR INVENTORY WITH ANOTHER ADDICT THAT THEY HAVE EXPERIENCED EVERYTHING YOU HAVE EITHER PHYSICALLY OR THEY HAVE THOUGHT ABOUT DOING IT. MANY OF THE PEOPLE, PLACES, EVENTS, AND CIRCUMSTANCES MAY BE DIFFERENT, BUT THE FEELINGS ARE THE SAME. AFTER DOING THIS STEP YOU WILL HAVE A MUCH BETTER UNDERSTANDING OF THE WE OF THIS PROGRAM. NOW IS THE TIME TO GO FORWARD, PRAY TO THE HIGHER POWER OF YOUR UNDERSTANDING AND SET A TIME TO SIT WITH YOUR NA SPONSOR TO DO YOUR FIFTH STEP.

WRITE OUT THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS AND ANSWER ON A SEPARATE PAPER AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR:

1. WHY IS IT NECESSARY TO DO A FIFTH STEP?

2. WRITE IN THE GIFT I WILL RECEIVE IN MY RECOVERY FROM DOING A FIFTH STEP.

3. WHAT TYPE OF SPIRITUAL AWAKENING WILL I RECEIVE FROM THE FIFTH STEP?

SPONSOR/SPONSEE SIXTH STEP WORKSHEET

"WE WERE ENTIRELY READY TO HAVE GOD REMOVE ALL THESE DEFECTS OF CHARACTER."

ENTIRELY READY ARE KEY WORDS IN THIS STEP. THE VERY ACT OF LIVING THE STEPS 1 THROUGH 5 MAKES US ENTIRELY READY, WE JUST NEED TO RECOGNIZE THIS AND KNOW OUR DEFECTS CAN BE REMOVED. A QUESTION THAT IS ALWAYS ASKED IS, HOW DOES GOD REMOVE ALL THESE DEFECTS OF CHARACTER? THE ANSWER CAN BE FOUND IN THE THIRD STEP. BEFORE WE CAN USE THE THIRD STEP IN RELATION TO THE SIXTH STEP, WE MUST DO SOME FOOTWORK. OUR HIGHER POWER WILL ALWAYS WORK THROUGH US, AND OTHER RECOVERING ADDICTS AS LONG AS WE ARE WILLING TO PROVIDE THE PERSPIRATION OUR HIGHER POWER WILL PROVIDE THE MOTIVATION.

ONE WAY WE DO THE FOOTWORK IS TO MAKE A LIST OF ALL OUR DEFECTS. ON ONE SIDE OF A PIECE OF PAPER WITH A LINE DRAWN DOWN THE CENTER OF THE PAPER. ACROSS FROM EACH DEFECT ON THE OTHER SIDE OF THE LINE WE LIST THE OPPOSITE OF EACH DEFECT SUCH AS:

INTOLERANCE	TOLERANCE
FEAR	COURAGE
RESENTMENTS	FORGIVENESS

AFTER WE HAVE COMPLETED THIS LIST TO THE BEST OF OUR ABILITY, WE CAN NOW FOCUS ON ASSETS WE WISH TO HAVE. THIS BECOMES A GOAL.

NOW THAT WE ARE ENTIRELY READY TO HAVE GOD REMOVE THESE DEFECTS OF CHARACTER, WE WILL MOVE ON THE THE SEVENTH STEP. MOST OF US, BEING THE ADDICTS WE ARE WILL SAY THIS SOUNDS TOO SIMPLE, BUT REMEMBER THE SIXTH STEP: SAY "WE WERE ENTIRELY READY TO HAVE GOD REMOVE ALL THESE DEFECTS OF CHARACTER" AND THIS IS WHAT WE DID, BECAME ENTIRELY READY. DURING THE FOURTH STEP WE COME IN TOUCH WITH OUR INNERMOST FEELINGS AND OURSELVES, DURING OUR FIFTH STEP WE SHARE THIS WITH OUR HIGHER POWER, OURSELVES AND ANOTHER HUMAN BEING. DURING THE SIXTH STEP WE USED THE INFORMATION FROM THE FOURTH AND FIFTH TO SEE OUR DEFECTS OF CHARACTER AND PATTERNS. WE LOOKED AT THEM AND WENT THROUGH THE WORK OF LISTING THEM ON PAPER. ALL OF THIS ADDS UP TO BEING ENTIRELY READY.

WRITE ON A SEPARATE SHEET OF PAPER AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR:

1. WHAT IS THE KEY WORD OF THIS STEP AND WHAT DO THOSE WORDS MEAN TO ME?

2. WHEN DID WE BECOME AWARE THAT WE ARE ENTIRELY READY?

3.HOW DOES GOD REMOVE THESE DEFECTS OF CHARACTER?

4. WHAT DO I REPLACE MY DEFECTS WITH?

5. WRITE YOUR LIST OF DEFECTS AND THEIR OPPOSITES.

SPONSOR/SPONSEE SEVENTH STEP WORKSHEET

"WE HUMBLY ASKED HIM TO REMOVE OUR SHORTCOMINGS."

LET'S TALK ABOUT SHORTCOMINGS BEFORE WE GET INTO THIS STEP. ARE SHORTCOMINGS THE SAME AS DEFECTS? THE ANSWER IS YES AND NO. AS STRANGE AS THAT MIGHT SEEM IT IS TRUE. WE SAY THEY ARE THE SAME BECAUSE THEY HAVE THEIR ROOTS IN THE DEFECT. WE SAY THEY ARE DIFFERENT BECAUSE THE SHORTCOMING IS THE ACTING OUT OF THE DEFECT. YOU ARE WAITING TO PICK UP SOMEBODY FOR A MEETING. YOU ARE DOING THEM A FAVOR AND GOING OUT OF THE WAY. AT 7:00 PM YOU ARRIVE ON TIME. IT'S NOW 7:20 PM AND THEY ARE NOT READY YET AND YOU MIGHT BE LATE FOR THE MEETING. AT THIS POINT MANY SHORTCOMINGS OF THE DEFECT OF IMPATIENCE ARE ABOUT TO BE ACTED OUT. YOU MAY GET ANGRY, FRUSTRATED AND RESENTFUL. THESE ARE SHORTCOMINGS THAT ARE BORN OF A DEFECT. MANY OF THE SAME SHORTCOMINGS COME FROM DIFFERENT DEFECTS.

IN THE SIXTH STEP WE BECAME ENTIRELY READY TO HAVE GOD REMOVE ALL THESE DEFECTS OF CHARACTER. IN THE SEVENTH STEP WE WILL SEE HOW GOD DOES THIS WHEN WE HUMBLY ASK HIM TO REMOVE OUR SHORTCOMINGS. BEFORE WE ACTUALLLY LEARN HOW TO APPLY THIS STEP, LET'S LOOK AT WHAT THE 7TH STEP SAYS.

IT STARTS OUT BY SAYING, "WE HUMBLY ASKED HIM." WHEN WE RECOGNIZE THE FACT THAT WE ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR OUR SHORTCOMINGS EVEN THOUGH WE ARE NOT RESPONSIBLE FOR OUR DEFECTS, WE LEARNED WE WERE NOT RESPONSIBLE FOR HAVING THE DISEASE DEFECTS ARE PART OF AND THEREFORE PART OF US. THEY WILL ALWAYS BE THERE, BUTH THEY CAN BE ARRESTED. THAT IS HOW THEY ARE REMOVED.

NOW UNDERSTANDING THAT SHORTCOMINGS OR ACTING OUT OUR DEFECT IS OUR RESPONSIBILITY. WE BECOME HUMBLE WHEN WE ACCEPT THIS. WHAT WE DID WAS JUST APPLY A FIRST STEP ON OUR SHORTCOMINGS. NEXT WE SEE THE INSANITY OF ACTING OUT OUR SHORTCOMINGS AND DECIDE TO ACT DIFFERENTLY. WE JUST APPLIED THE SECOND STEP TO OUR SHORTCOMINGS. NEXT WE DECIDE TO TURN OUR LIVES AND OUR SHORTCOMINGS TO THE CARE OF GOD OF OUR UNDERSTANDING. THIS WILL GIVE US THE STRENGTH AND THE COURAGE TO ACT MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE. WE HAVE JUST APPLIED A THIRD STEP TO OUR SHORTCOMINGS. THE SOLUTION OF ALL OUR PROBLEMS CAN BE FOUND IN THE STEPS. THE FIRST THREE STEPS BECOME THE FOUNDATION OF OUR SOLUTIONS AND THE 10TH, 11TH, 12TH STEPS ARE THE WAY WE KEEP OUR SOLUTIONS WORKING. THIS IS A LIFETIME PROCESS BECAUSE OUR DISEASE IS ALWAYS WITH US, WAITING FOR US TO

LET OUR SPIRITUAL GUARD DOWN SO IT CAN STRIKE AT US. THIS IS WHY WE GO TO MEETINGS THE REST OF OUR LIVES AND STAY CLOSE TO NA PEOPLE, SO THAT WE STAY GREEN. REMEMBER WHEN YOU'RE GREEN, YOU ARE GROWING. WHEN YOU ARE RIPE, YOU BEGIN TO ROT.

1. WHAT IS THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN DEFECTS AND SHORTCOMINGS?

2. HOW DO WE BECOME HUMBLE?

3. WHAT ARE SHORTCOMINGS?

4. HOW DO WE KEEP OUR DISEASE FROM RESURFACING?

5. WHAT ARE DEFECTS?

6. WHY DO WE HAVE TO GO TO MEETINGS AS LONG AS WE ARE ALIVE?

SPONSOR/SPONSEE EIGHTH STEP WORKSHEET

"WE MADE A LIST OF ALL PEOPLE WE HAD HARMED, AND BECAME WILLING TO MAKE AMENDS TO THEM ALL."

MANY ADDICTS BECOME OVERWHELMED WHEN THEY START THIS STEP. MOST OF US DON'T UNDERSTAND WHY WE HAVE TO DEAL WITH THIS PART OF OUR PAST. WE FEEL WE DEALT AS BEST WE COULD WITH THESE THINGS WHEN WE DID THE 4TH AND 5TH STEPS AND THEREFORE WE ARE NOT VERY WILLING TO MAKE A LIST. THE THING WE MUST REMEMBER IS THAT THE STEP DOES NOT SAY BE WILLING AND MAKE A LIST. IT SIMPLY SAYS MAKE A LIST OF ALL PEOPLE WE HAD HARMED, AND (THEN) BECAME WILLING.

WE CAN NOW SEE THIS IS A TWO PART STEP. LET'S TALK ABOUT THE FIRST PART OF THE STEP - MAKING A LIST. THE FIRST TWO NAMES THAT SHOULD BE PUT ON OUR LIST ARE YOUR HIGHER POWER AND THEN YOURSELF. MANY TIMES WE GET STUCK WITH THE OLD CON, DID WE REALLY HARM THIS PERSON. IF THERE IS ANY DOUBT AT ALL LIST THEM. MANY TIMES DURING OUR ADDICTION THERE ARE MANY FACELESS PEOPLE IN OUR MEMORY THAT WE HARMED. NEVER REALLY KNOWING MANY OF THEM AND SOME WE JUST CAN'T REMEMBER THEIR NAMES. MAKE ONE ENTRY ON YOUR LIST CALLED FACELESS PROPLE. IN OUR 9TH STEP YOU WILL BE TOLD WHAT TO DO WITH THEM. ONCE YOUR LIST HAS BEEN DONE WE ARE READY TO WORK ON THE SECOND HALF OF THE STEP.

THIS PART OF THE STEP CAN BE VERY DIFFICULT FOR SOME OF US IF WE APPROACH IT WITH THE WRONG ATTITUDE. WE MUST ACCEPT THE FACT THAT NA SAYS WE MUST LIVE ALL THE STEPS IN OUR LIVES IF WE ARE TO HAVE A PROGRAM OF RECOVERY. REMEMBER THE 1ST STEP WAS OUR PAST AND THE THIGS OF OUR PAST THAT ARE WITH US TODAY. THE NEXT 11 STEPS WERE TO BE OUR FUTURE. IF WE ARE TO HAVE ANY FUTURE THAT IS PRODUCTIVE AND MANAGEABLE WE MUST TAKE THE RESPONSIBILITY TO BE WILLING. THE WAY WE DO THIS IS FIRST TO ACCEPT WE ARE POWERLESS AND SURRENDER WE MUST DO THIS. FIRST STEP APPLIED TO THE 8TH. NEXT WE MUST REALIZE WE CAN'T AFFORD TO BE UNWILLING. WE MUST DO A DIFFERENT WAY, BE WILLING. IN OTHER WORDS, ACT MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE AND MAKE AMENDS.

WE HAVE JUST APPLIED A 3RD STEP TO THE 8TH. THROUGHOUT THESE WORKSHEETS WE TALK ABOUT THE FIRST THREE STEPS IN RELATION TO THE OTHER STEPS. BY NOW YOU MUST REALIZE HOW THOSE STEPS MUST BE LIVED AND APPLIED TO EVERY AREA OF OUR LIVES. WITHOUT THE STEPS WE ARE LIVING DEAD.

ON A SEPARATE PIECE OF PAPER WRITE ON THE FOLLOWING AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR.

1. HOW MANY PARTS ARE THERE TO THIS STEP?

2. WHY MUST YOU START THIS STEP EVEN IF YOU ARE NOT WILLING?

3. WHY MUST ALL THE STEPS BE LIVED?

4. HOW DO I BECOME WILLING?

5. HOW ARE THE FIRST THREE STEPS USED IN THE 8TH STEP?

SPONSOR/SPONSEE NINTH STEP WORKSHEET

"WE MADE DIRECT AMENDS TO SUCH PROPLE WHEREVER POSSIBLE, EXCEPT WHEN TO DO SO WOULD INJURE THEM OR OTHERS."

THIS IS QUITE SIMPLE WHEN WE APPROACH WITH AN ATTITUDE OF POSITIVE EXPECTANCY. THIS IS THE LAST OF THE CLEANSING AND RELEASING STEPS. MANY DOORS IN OUR RECOVERY WILL BEGIN TO OPEN FOR US AFTER WE COMPLETE THIS STEP. OUR GROWTH WILL ASTOUND US. KNOWING THIS ALONE CAN GIVE US AN ATTITUDE OF POSITIVE EXPECTANCY.

WE DO EXACTLY AS THIS STEP SAYS WE MAKE DIRECT AMENDS TO SUCH PEOPLE WHEREVER POSSIBLE. BUT WHAT ABOUT THOSE PEOPLE WE NO LONGER KNOW WHERE THEY ARE OF THOSE WE NEVER KNEW WHO THEY WERE, ALL THOSE FACELESS PEOPLE.

REMEMBER THE FIRST NAME WE PUT ON OUR LIST, OUR HIGHER POWER. WE CAN MAKE AMENDS THROUGH OUR HIGHER POWER TO ALL THOSE FACELESS PROPLE AND THOSE WE CANNOT LOCATE. THE SECOND NAME ON OUR LIST, OURSELVES. A QUESTION WE MAY ASK IS HOW DO WE MAKE AMENDS TO OURSELVES. WE MUST REALIZE WE STARTED TO MAKE AMENDS TO OURSELVES THE DAY WE WALKED INTO NA. WE CONTINUE TO MAKE AMENDS TO OURSELVES AS WE LIVE THE STEPS AND CARRY THE MESSAGE OF NA TO OTHER ADDICTS. WE CAN NEVER GIVE AWAY MORE THAN WE HAVE, BECAUSE AS SOON AS WE GIVE IT AWAY OUR HIGHER POWER GIVES US TWICE AS MUCH AS WE GAVE.

THE NEXT PART OF THE STEP "EXCEPT WHEN TO DO SO WOULD INJURE THEM OR OTHERS." WE MUST REMEMBER SOMETIME IN TRYING TO MAKE AMENDS. THE AMEND ITSELF MAY INJURE THE PERSON YOU ARE TRYING TO MAKE AMENDS TO. LET ME EXPLAIN FOR INSTANCE SOMEONE YOU INJURED IN YOUR ADDICTION BY STEALING FROM. THEY TRUSTED YOU AND NEVER KNEW YOU STOLE FROM THEM. IN VERBALLY MAKING THE AMEND YOU MAY INJURE THEM BY SHOCKING THEM AND CAUSING THEM TO HAVE A RESENTMENT. YOU MAY WANT TO HANDLE THIS AMEND BY ANONYMOUSLY REIMBURSING THEM AND MAKE YOUR AMENDS THROUGH YOUR HIGHER POWER. IT IS IMPORTANT TO GO OVER EACH OF YOUR AMENDS WITH YOUR SPONSOR TO GET DIRECTION ON HOW TO MAKE EACH OF YOUR AMENDS SO YOU DON'T INJURE THEM. ALSO, WHEN THE STEP REFERS TO THEN AND OTHER, YOU ARE PART OF OTHERS. YOU MUST MAKE SURE THAT AMEND DOES NO INJURE YOU. THAT WOULD BE PURE IRRESPONSIBILITY. AGAIN, I MUST STRESS THAT YOU GO OVER YOUR LIST ONE BY ONE WITH YOUR SPONSOR.

ONE LAST WORD ON YOUR 9TH STEP. MANY ADDICTS WOULD LIKE TO JUSTIFY WHY NOT TO MAKE AMENDS. IT IS OUR DISEASE. THE STEP DOESN'T SAY OTHERS ARE TO MAKE AMENDS TO US. NO MATTER WHAT THEY DID TO US, THIS STEP TELLS US WE ARE

TO MAKE DIRECT AMENDS.

WRITE THE ANSWERS ON A SEPARATE SHEET OF PAPER AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR.

1. WHAT TYPE OF ATTITUDE MUST WE HAVE WHEN WE DO THIS STEP AND WHY?

2. HOW DO WE MAKE AMENDS TO PROPLE WE CAN'T LOCATE?

3. UNDER WHAT CERTAIN CIRCUMSTANCES CAN AMENDS INJURE SOMEONE?

4. WHY IS IT IMPORTANT TO GO OVER YOUR LIST WITH YOUR SPONSOR?

SPONSOR/SPONSEE TENTH STEP WORKSHEET

"WE CONTINUED TO TAKE PERSONAL INVENTORY AND WHEN WE WERE WRONG PROMPTLY ADMITTED IT."

THIS IS THE FIRST OF THE MAINTENANCE STEPS. IT IS A VERY IMPORTANT STEP BECAUSE IT COVERS THE FOURTH THROUGH THE FIFTH STEPS ON A DAILY BASIS. BY TAKING A DAILY INVENTORY WE CAN ELIMINATE THE BUILDUP OF MANY OF THE THINGS WE DEALT WITH FROM THE 4TH THROUGH 9TH STEPS.

WE APPROACH THIS STEP IN TWO PARTS. LET'S TALK ABOUT THE FIRST PART PERSONAL INVENTORY. PERSONAL INVENTORY IS THEN DIVIDED INTO TWO PARTS. THE FIRST PART IS GOING OVER OUR DAY. GETTING IN TOUCH WITH THE WAY WE HANDLED THINGS THROUGHOUT THE DAY GOOD AND BAD. THE SECOND THING WE DO IN THIS STEP IS WE TAKE THE THINGS WE DID NOT HANDLE WELL AND TAKE A LOOK AT THEM. AFTER WE DO THAT, WE GO TO THE FIRST STEP AND ADMIT WE DID NOT HANDLE THEM WELL BECAUSE OF OUR ADDICTION. WE NOW GO TO THE SECOND STEP AND SEE HOW WE COULD HAVE HANDLED THEM DIFFERENTLY AND FINALLY WE GO TO THE THIRD STEP AND MAKE A DECISION TO TURN THEM OVER TO THE CARE OF THE GOD OF OUR UNDER-STANDING TO HELP US HANDLE THEM IN A MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE WAY. AGAIN WE SEE THE IMPORTANCE OF THE FIRST THREE STEPS IN RELATION TO THE OTHER STEPS.

THE SECOND PART OF THE STEP DEALS WITH "WHEN WE ARE WRONG WE PROMPTLY ADMITTED IT." THERE IS A LOT OF CONFUSION ABOUT THIS PART OF THE STEP. MANY ADDICTS SEEM TO THINK IT MEANS GO ON WITH SORRYITUS. ALTHOUGH APOLOGIES IS A PART OF IT THERE IS MUCH MORE. "WE PROMPTLY ADMITTED IT." APPLIES TO SELF HONESTY WHICH IS VERY IMPORTANT WHEN WE TAKE OUR PERSONAL INVENTORY. WHEN WE ARE WRONG WE MUST PROMPTLY ADMIT IT TO OURSELVES IF WE ARE TO DO ANYTHING ABOUT IT.

MANY TIMES AS ADDICTS WE WILL GO AROUND TELLING EVERYONE THAT WE ARE SORRY. THAT IS NOT THE ANSWER. AS SORRY MEANS NOTHING IF WE CONTINUE TO KEEP DOING THE SAME THING OVER AND OVER AGAIN. WE MUST USE SELF HONESTY TO ADMIT OUR WRONG TO OURSELVES SO THAT WE CAN APPLY THE FIRST THREE STEPS TO THE SITUATION. THIS TAKES PRACTICE, PRACTICE AND PRACTICE, TO LEARN TO LIVE THE STEPS WE MUST PRACTICE THE STEPS. WE MUST NOT STRIVE FOR PERFECTION BUT WE MUST STRIVE TO PRACTICE THESE STEPS DAILY. ONE LAST THING TO SAY ON THIS STEP IS THAT THE QUESTION KEEPS COMING UP IS, SHOULD THIS STEP BE DONE MENTALLY OR WITH PAPER AND PENCIL. IN THE BEGINNING THIS SHOULD BE DONE WITH PAPER AND PEN. AS YOU GAIN

EXPERIENCE WITH PRACTICING THE STEPS YOU BEGIN TO DO IT MENTALLY.

ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS ON A SEPARATE PIECE OF PAPER AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR.

1. WHAT IS A PERSONAL INVENTORY?

2. HOW DO YOU DO A PERSONAL INVENTORY?

3. WHEN YOU WERE WRONG, PROMPTLY ADMIT IT. WHAT DOES THIS MEAN?

4. IN WHAT WAY DO THE FIRST THREE STEPS APPLY TO THE 10TH STEP?

5. WHY IS THE 10TH STEP NECESSARY?

SPONSOR/SPONSEE ELEVENTH STEP WORKSHEET

"WE SOUGHT THROUGH PRAYER AND MEDITATION TO IMPROVE OUR CONSCIOUS CONTACT WITH GOD AS WE UNDERSTOOD HIM, PRAYING ONLY FOR KNOWLEDGE OF HIS WILL FOR US AND THE POWER TO CARRY THAT OUT."

HERE IN THE 11TH STEP ALL THE WORK WE PUT INTO THE STEPS SEEMS TO ALL COME TOGETHER. AS WE LEARNED TO LIVE THE PREVIOUS 10TH STEP WE HAVE BEEN PRACTICING PRAYER AND MEDITATION EVEN THOUGH WE MAY NOT BE AWARE OF IT.

OUR STARTING POINT HERE WILL BE TO CONSISTENTLY IMPROVE PRAYER AND MEDITATION TO THE GOD OF OUR UNDERSTANDING. THE PROGRAM OF NA IS NOT ABOUT TELLING YOU HOW TO PRAY AND MEDITATE. THAT IS TECHNIQUE THAT IS DEVELOPED BY YOURSELF IN RELATION TO YOUR HIGHER POWER AND THE WAY YOU FEEL COMFORTABLE. HOWEVER MANY ADDICTS KEEP ASKING HOW DO I PRAY. HOW DO I MEDITATE? THE FOLLOWING ARE WAYS SOME ADDICTS PRAY AND MEDITATE. THESE EXAMPLES ARE HERE ONLY TO GIVE YOU SOME PLACE TO START AND DEVELOP YOUR OWN WAY. YOU WILL KNOW WHICH WAY IS RIGHT FOR YOU BY THE WAY YOU FEEL. THE FEELING OF SERENITY AND STRESS WILL TELL YOU THAT YOU HAVE MADE CONSCIOUS CONTACT. ONE OF THE FOLLOWING MAY FIT YOUR NEEDS OR YOU MAY DEVELOP YOUR OWN. REMEMBER IT IS A GOD OF YOUR UNDERSTANDING AND A CONSCIOUS CONTACT YOU CAN RELATE TO. HERE ARE SOME EXAMPLES OF HOW DIFFERENT ADDICTS PRAY.

1. SIMPLY TELLING A HIGHER POWER THANK YOU AND FEELING GRATITUDE FOR ALL THE THINGS THAT ENRICHED MY LIFE. AN ATTITUDE OF GRATITUDE.

2. ANOTHER ADDICT MAY SIMPLY FEEL COMFORTABLE GETTING ON HIS KNEES AND SAYING THANKS AND ASKING FOR THINGS HE NEEDS SUCH AS STRENGTH, COURAGE, ETC.

3. ANOTHER ADDICT'S FORM OF PRAYER MAY BE SIMPLY GETTING IN A SITTING OR LYING POSITION, TOTALLY RELAXED AND GIVING THANKS AND ASKING FOR NEED.

4. ANOTHER ADDICT MAY SIMPLY PRAY BY WALKING, GETTING IN TOUCH WITH NATURE AND GIVING THANKS AND ASKING.

HERE ARE SOME EXAMPLES OF HOW SOME ADDICTS MEDITATE.

1. LAYING OR SITTING AND GETTING A FEELING OF SERENITY AND JUST BATHING IN IT.

2. WALKING AND FEELING SERENE BY GETTING IN TOUCH WITH

THE NATURE AROUND US.

3. SITTING AND LOOKING AT A PICTURE OF A BEAUTIFUL SCENE OR SEEING THE SCENE IN MY MIND AND GETTING SERENE AND AT PEACE.

THERE IS NO SET WAY. IT IS A PERSONAL DECISION BETWEEN YOU AND YOUR HIGHER POWERS'. PRAYER IS THE ASKING PART. MEDITATION IS THE LISTENING PART. MEDITATION IS NECESSARY. LET ME GIVE YOU AN EXAMPLE WHY. IF YOU HAD A FRIEND WHO DID THE TALKING ALL THE TIME AND NEVER TOOK TIME TO HEAR YOU, EVENTUALLY HE OR SHE WOULD NO LONGER BE YOUR FRIEND. PRAYER IS THE TALKING AND MEDITATION IS THE LISTENING.

"ONLY FOR KNOWLEDGE OF HIS WILL AND POWER TO CARRY THAT OUT." IS THE NEXT PART OF THE STEP. AS WE PRACTICE THESE PRINCIPLES IN OUR LIFE THE CARE OF OUR DISEASE SELF CENTEREDNESS WILL BECOME ARRESTED AND WE WILL BEGIN TO ACT IN A MORE MATURE AND RESPONSIBLE WAY IN ALL OF OUR AFFAIRS. AN AWARENESS OF THIS BEGINS TO BECOME KNOWN TO OURSELVES AND WE DISCOVER THAT GOD'S WILL FOR US IS TO PRACTICE THESE STEPS IN OUR LIVES AND WE GAIN THIS POWER THROUGH PRAYER AND MEDITATION.

ON A SEPARATE SHEET OF PAPER ANSWER THE FOLLOWING AND RETURN TO YOUR SPONSOR.

1. WHAT IS A PRAYER?

2. WHAT IS MEDITATION?

3. WHY IS PRAYER AND MEDITATION NECESSARY?

4. IS THERE ANY CERTAIN WAYS TO PRAY AND MEDITATE?